

Writing software, except for the LG LW60. The Fujitsu came with Norman Virus Control CD, whereas the others came with Norton Antivirus 2005, except for the MSI laptops—which came with no AntiVirus software at all. DVD players such as PowerDVD and WinDVD came with almost every laptop, while some such as the MSI laptops even had a bundled game DVD.

The Acer, Fujitsu and MSI were the only ones that came with a leather carry case. A screen wiping cloth was provided with the Acer and Fujitsu.

A Bluetooth mouse was bundled with the Acer Ferrari. A remote was bundled with the Fujitsu and MSI Megabook M630 for standalone DVD/Audio CD functionality.

Performance

ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004

The Acer Ferrari stood first in ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004, with a score of 21.5. The Fujitsu LBN3210 and the Samsung X20 were close behind with 20.9 and 20.2 respectively. The lowest score was 14.2, by the MSI Megabook M630, possibly due to its (weaker) Sempron processor. This laptop was the slowest in the video encoding test as well, where it took 214 seconds to encode the video. There was a tie for first place in the video encoding test, with the Fujitsu, LG and both Samsung notebooks completing the encoding task in 186 seconds.

SiSoft Sandra 2005

In the SiSoft Sandra 2005 CPU benchmarks, the IBM T43 scored the highest. The Fujitsu, LG and the Samsung laptops scored more or less the same. In the memory benchmarks, the Samsung R50 scored the highest, while the MSI Megabook M630 scored the lowest, possibly due to its lower amount of (slower) memory. None came even close to the file system benchmark scores of the IBM T43, which scored a drive index of 33 MB/s. The Acer Ferrari scored the next best drive index of 30 MB/s.

Game Test

In the game test, as was expected, the Acer Ferrari with the PCI-Express ATi Radeon X700 zoomed past the others, scoring 154 fps in *Call of Duty* and 84.88 in *FarCry*. The Samsung R50 with the PCI-Express ATi X300 and the Samsung X20 with the ATi Radeon 9600 also scored well in the gaming tests. The MSI Megabook M630, with the SiS 330 Mirage graphics chip, failed the *Call of Duty* test because it couldn't meet the minimum hardware requirements of the game.

PCMark 04

The Samsung X20 scored 3,551 PCMarks which was the highest, followed by 3,524 by the Fujitsu LBN3510. For an unknown reason, the LG LW60 kept crashing in PCMark 04. We even reinstalled the OS to see if this could be gotten around, but PCMark still crashed.

DisplayMate

There was no clear winner in the DisplayMate test. But in the viewing angle test, the Fujitsu was the clear winner: the text viewing angle was 170 degrees, and the movie viewing angle 160 degrees.

Battery life

The Samsung R50's battery lasted the longest—179 minutes. Not far behind were the Acer Ferrari and the LG LW60 Express, with battery lives of 175 minutes each. The MSI Megabook M630 couldn't go beyond 122 minutes.

Wi-Fi test

With a NetCPS score of 2.12, the Fujitsu LBN3510 was the highest scorer in this test. The Acer Ferrari, with 802.11g, scored just 1.26 and was justifiably placed last. In the file copying test, the MSI M630 which featured 802.11g was the slowest, taking 123 seconds to copy our data. The Samsung R50, LG LW60 and the MSI M520 took 45 seconds and stood first.

Flaunt value

The Acer Ferrari stood apart from the rest of the laptops. It was different in many ways—all the necessary features were there, such as Bluetooth and infrared, and it could read every type of memory card. Its ATi X700 PCI-Express card put it ahead in the gaming tests. It has a unique, rich chequered design, and the Ferrari logo on the outside as well as on the